

Knock

PURPOSE

Knock is a private, building-specific social app that lets apartment residents communicate with the people who live around them.

The goal is to make apartment buildings feel less anonymous. Residents should be able to ask for help, meet neighbors, organize events, talk about shared amenities, sell or give away items, find workout partners, report building issues, and build small communities within their building.

Apartment buildings are full of people who live steps away from each other but rarely have an easy way to connect. Knock gives every building its own private community with channels for general chat, help, events, marketplace, pets, sports, gym, pool, lost and found, and everyday building life.

CORE PROBLEM

Most apartment residents do not know or communicate with their neighbors, even though they share the same building, amenities, package room, gym, pool, elevators, lobby, mailroom, and day-to-day issues.

Existing options are imperfect:

Nextdoor is too broad and neighborhood-based.

WhatsApp or GroupMe only works if someone already organized the group.

Building portals are usually management-focused, not social.

Slack or Discord is too generic and not designed for verified residents.

Flyers in elevators are outdated and temporary.

Knock solves this by creating a verified, building-only communication layer.

USE CASES

Everyday help: Residents can ask for small favors or urgent help.

- “Does anyone have salt?”, “Can someone lend me a screwdriver?”

Building chat: Residents can talk about building-specific things.

- “Is the elevator working?”, “Is the package room locked?”

Events and social: Residents can create casual building events.

- Rooftop drinks, Game night, Watch party

Sports, gym, and amenities: Residents can organize around shared amenities.

- “Anyone want to play basketball?”, “Looking for a gym partner”

Marketplace: Residents can buy, sell, give away, or trade items.

- “Giving away a desk”, “selling a tv”

Lost and found: Residents can post found or missing items.

- Keys, Wallets, AirPods

Recommendations: Residents can ask others in the building for local advice.

- Best dry cleaner nearby, babysitter, local restaurants

Building issues: Residents can discuss shared issues, without replacing formal maintenance.

- Noise issue, broken laundry, package theft

MAIN PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

The app is organized around **buildings** and **channels**.

Each apartment building has its own private Knock community. Inside that community, residents have access to channels based on what they care about.

Example: The Mason Apartments

Channels:

- General
- Help
- Events
- Marketplace
- Gym
- Pool
- Sports

- Pets
- Lost & Found
- Building Issues
- Recommendations
- Announcements

CORE FEATURE SET

- 1) Building Community
- 2) Channels
- 3) Posts/Messages
- 4) Events
- 5) Marketplace (or just marketplace channel?)
- 6) DMs
- 7) Profiles
- 8) Verification

Question:

- Events Page?

USER FLOW:

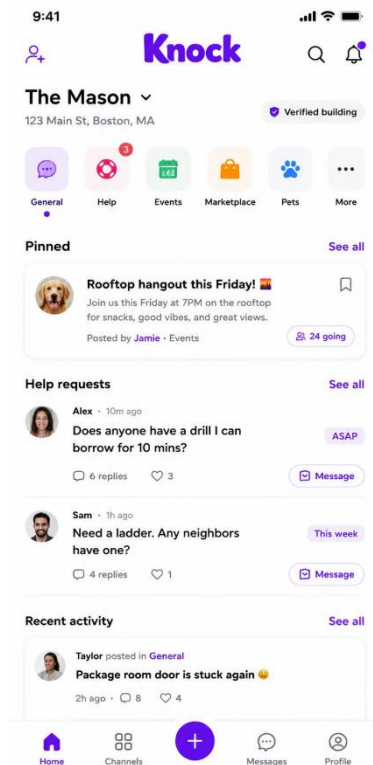
1. New User

- Welcome Screen:
 - Knock logo
 - “Ask Your Building”
 - The private community app for your apartment building.
 - “Get Started” Rounded purple button

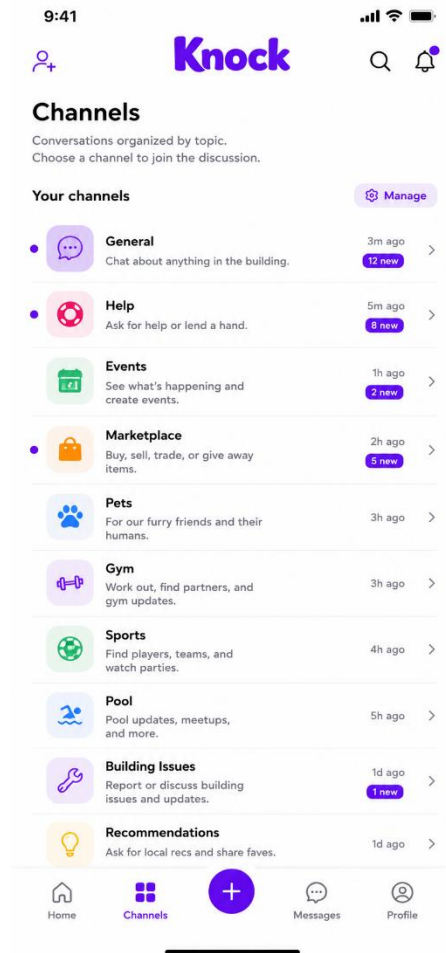


- Something like this^ but, move the get started button higher, fix spacing
- Enter phone number
- SMS code confirmation
- “Find Your Building” Screen
 - ? User sees search bar:
 - “Search your building name or address”
 - User types building name or address.
 - App shows suggested results.
 - Example:
 - The Mason
123 Main St, Boston, MA
 - The Mason North Tower
125 Main St, Boston, MA
 - User taps the correct building.
 - App shows building confirmation screen:
 - **Is this your building?**
The Mason
123 Main St, Boston, MA

- User taps **Yes, this is my building.**
- Verification step
 - Geolocation? If so, can say “make sure you are in your building” and can ask for location permission
- Profile Setup Screen
 - User enters name
 - User enters display name
 - Optional profile photo
 - Choose interests?
 - Accept notifications
- Building Home Screen

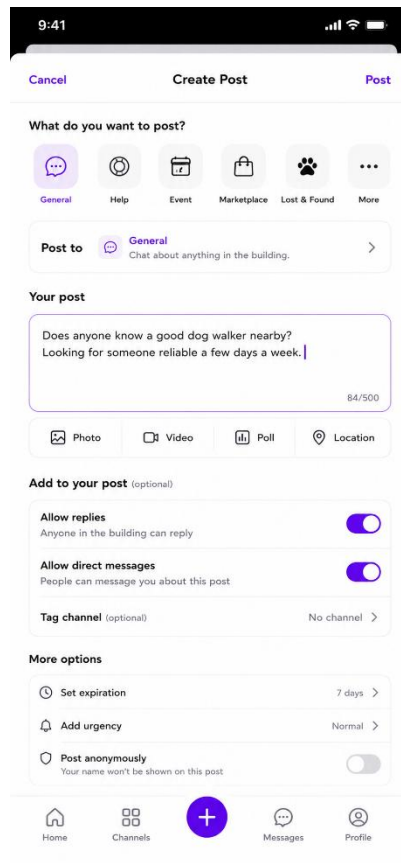


- Use this for reference^
- Channels

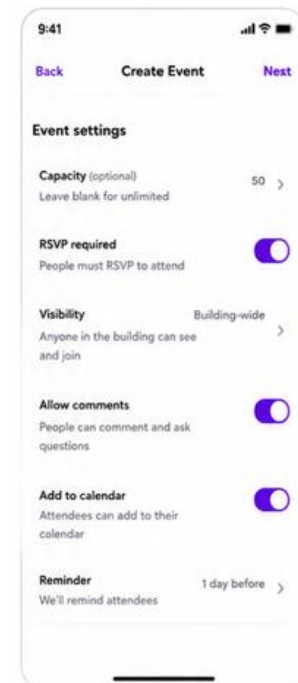
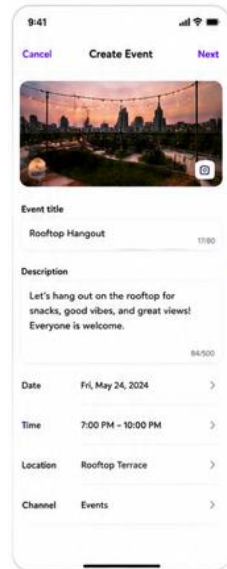


- reference^
- Create Post

-

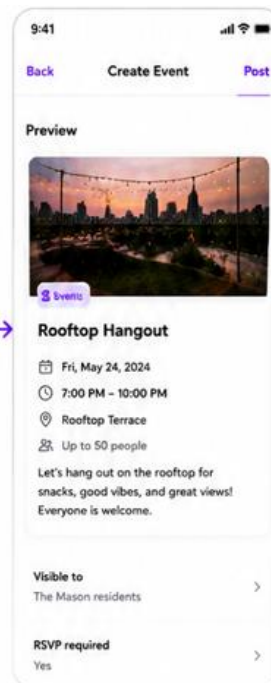


- Reply to post functionality
- DM functionality
 - User taps Message on a post.
 - If dms are allowed, chat opens
 - Sender sends a message
- Events



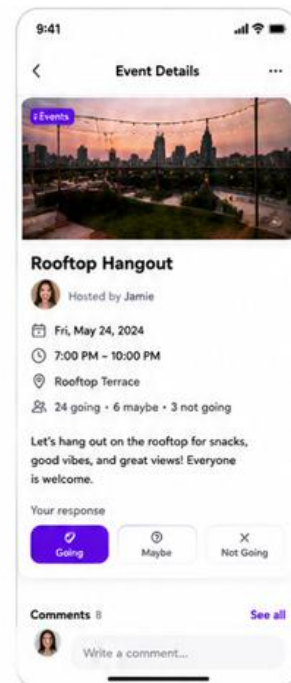
4 Configure settings

Set capacity, visibility, RSVP options, and reminders.



5 Preview & Post

Review your event and tap Post Event.



6 Event is live!

People can view, RSVP, and comment on your event.

Users can rsvp to events

- Notifications for users:
 - Reply to your post
 - DMs
 - Event RSVP update

- Event reminders
- New post in followed channel
- Etc
- Additional flows:
 - User moves out/changes buildings
 - User opens Profile.
 - User taps **My Building**.
 - User selects:
 - I moved out
 - Switch building
 - Add another building, future
 - App asks for confirmation.
 - User loses posting access to old building.
 - User may retain limited read access for short grace period, optional.
 - User searches/verifies new building.
 - User Joins Building With Low Activity
 - App welcomes user:
 - “You’re one of the first residents here.”
 - Invites user to:
 - Invite neighbors (**GIVES SHAREABLE LINK**)
 - Create an event
 - Post
 - App can provide starter prompts